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CRM Implementation Guide

A five-stage plan for rolling out CRM without losing team adoption.

Why CRM rollouts stall

Most failed CRM projects don't fail on features — they fail on adoption. Three patterns show up repeatedly: the system launches before processes are mapped, sales teams see it as data entry rather than a tool that helps them sell, and there's no one person accountable for making the rollout stick after week one.

The five-stage rollout

1. Discovery & data audit — Map your current pipeline stages and audit existing contact data for duplicates before anything gets migrated.

2. Process mapping — Define what happens at each pipeline stage in plain language before configuring a single field.

3. Pilot with one team — Run the CRM with a single sales team or region for 2–3 weeks before a full rollout.

4. Full rollout & training — Train by role, not by feature list — a rep and a sales manager need different walkthroughs.

5. Adoption tracking & iteration — Review usage weekly for the first month and adjust fields or stages that aren't being used.

Data migration checklist

- ■ Deduplicate contacts and companies before import, not after
- ■ Map custom fields from your old system deliberately — don't import everything by default
- ■ Assign a data owner for the first 90 days post-launch

KPIs worth tracking early

Login frequency by rep, percentage of deals with an updated stage in the last 7 days, and average lead response time. These three tell you whether the system is being used, long before revenue-level metrics move.

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Want help scoping your rollout? Email **hello@creatifyhub.com** or **0332-3468893**.